

Chapter 165-2

After a long while, Zhao Xuning opened her mouth, as if speaking was extremely difficult.

Shen Hui stared at her intently. "Are you going to say it or not?"

Seeing that Zhao Xuning still had no response, Shen Hui turned to leave.

But Zhao Xuning grabbed the hem of her clothes directly. "I want to be with you."

Zhao Xuning's voice was very soft. After she finished speaking, she repeated it again: "I want to be with you."

Shen Hui sneered coldly. "Didn't you say you'd give me your blessings? Is this your blessing?"

Zhao Xuning shook her head stubbornly, still clutching the hem of her clothes, looking disheveled and pitiful. "I'm sorry, I can't do it."

Shen Hui only glanced at her sideways, then turned her face away, gazing into the desolate distance. Her voice was mournful: "It's too late."

Zhao Xuning asked, "Why?"

Shen Hui didn't explain. She forcefully pried Zhao Xuning's hand away and said coldly, "Go home. Don't come again. You don't need to attend my wedding either."

Zhao Xuning's hand fell empty, hanging frozen in mid-air, still maintaining the posture of clutching at clothes.

Just as Shen Hui was about to get in the car, Zhao Xuning suddenly shouted in a torn voice, "Weren't you going to torment me? You should keep tormenting me! Why are you marrying someone else? This way I'll forget you quickly. You have to make me remember you forever... You..."

At this point, Shen Hui suddenly looked back.

Those light brown, aloof eyes swept over coldly, yet there were tears in them, making her look tender.

"Right now..." Shen Hui said, "I'm letting you go."

Shen Hui's car drove away from the bridge.

Zhao Xuning watched as the car disappeared from sight. Tears streamed down her face, yet her expression remained blank.

Liang Shi's heart ached just watching.

She never expected to come out in the middle of the night and witness such a heart-wrenching drama of painful love.

She walked over and pulled at Zhao Xuning. "Alright, let's go. You'll feel better after a good night's sleep."

Zhao Xuning remained wooden and expressionless.

Liang Shi couldn't persuade Zhao Xuning at all. She could only stand there like she was being punished, keeping her company.

Many people had already passed by, looking at Liang Shi with strange expressions. Those who didn't know better might have thought Liang Shi had done something to her.

Liang Shi wished she could carve a few big words on her face—*This has nothing to do with me.*

After waiting for who knows how long, Zhao Xuning suddenly stood up on her own, brushed the snow off herself, patted off the dirt, pulled her coat tighter, and walked toward the residential complex.

Liang Shi followed beside her, offering what comfort she could, useless as it was: "Go back and drink some hot water. Take your time coming to terms with things."

Zhao Xuning sniffled. "I can't come to terms with it."

Liang Shi: "..."

It sounded like she was just being contrary.

But then Zhao Xuning added seriously, "That person is terrible. She doesn't deserve Shen Hui."

Liang Shi: "?"

"Huh? Dr. Shen's taste can't be that bad, can it?" Liang Shi said. "Maybe you don't know her well enough?"

Zhao Xuning shook her head. "No, that person was in our class. Back then... she tampered with my experiment data because of scholarship issues."

Liang Shi: "..."

"Why is Dr. Shen involved with someone from your class?" Liang Shi asked.

Zhao Xuning: "...They work at the same hospital. That thing looks presentable on the surface but is a deceiver."

Liang Shi didn't know how she managed to fight off drowsiness and keep chatting with a drunk. But Zhao Xuning was trying her best not to seem drunk. If she hadn't nearly tripped over the low threshold when getting into the elevator, Liang Shi would have really thought she was sober.

Liang Shi wanted to take her home, but Zhao Xuning insisted on going back to the rooftop apartment.

After returning to the rooftop, she took off her shoes and walked barefoot on the floor. Even without turning on the lights, she could find her way to that bed without error.

As she lay face-down on the bed, she suddenly said, "I was quite a bastard. I wasn't good to Shen Hui before."

Liang Shi stood at the doorway and went to close the curtains in the room.

Zhao Xuning was still earnestly analyzing herself. "I thought too highly of myself. I don't talk much, and I have a bad temper. But I listened to her."

"I can spend the rest of my days making amends." Zhao Xuning said, "That thing is different. Who knows what she's after by being with Shen Hui? Is she after Shen Hui's money or Shen Hui herself? Will she mind that Shen Hui dated me before? Will she mind that Shen Hui was temporarily marked by me? Will she mind that Shen Hui had a miscarriage? Will she betray Shen Hui?"

Liang Shi went to get her some hot water while listening to her ramble on.

She thought she wouldn't be able to hear once she left the room, but Zhao Xuning followed her out to continue talking.

This was probably the most Zhao Xuning had ever spoken since Liang Shi had known her.

"I can't even guarantee any of that myself, but I know that thing has a bad personality. She even tortured and killed small animals. There used to be a stray cat under our teaching building. She lured it away with a piece of ham, then dissected it with a scalpel."

"At the time, I thought she must be really good at surgery—her hands didn't even shake holding the scalpel, and we were only freshmen! That thing is definitely a psychopath."

"Oh right, she also likes to litter. I once saw her spit out gum at the library entrance."

"Her face is the only thing that's somewhat okay. Everything else is a complete mess. Shen Hui has such a bad temper—she'll definitely fight with her."

"If they fight, Shen Hui will cry. When she cries..."

Zhao Xuning choked up as she spoke, then continued, "It breaks my heart."

"Don't be fooled by how gentle and agreeable Shen Hui seems. Actually, she has quite a temper too. If you don't buy her breakfast, she cries out of anger. If you don't listen to her, she twists your ear. If you raise your voice at her even slightly, she turns around and says you're being mean to her. You have to coax her, or she'll start crying."

Liang Shi: "..."

Liang Shi felt like she was being force-fed dog food.¹

Expired dog food, though.

She really wanted to record Zhao Xuning and play it on loop at her bedside tomorrow when she sobered up.

1. Dog food (狗粮): Chinese internet slang for public displays of affection between couples. "Eating dog food" means witnessing or being subjected to others' romantic displays, often making single people feel envious or uncomfortable. ↩